EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

Facilitator's Guide

DESCRIPTION	Utilize this facilitator's guide for: • Emotional Intelligence Video • Recognizing and Addressing Stress in Yourself and Others Resource Sheet • Utilizing Empathy Resource Sheet
OBJECTIVES	Participants should be able to: • Understand the difference between different elements of emotional intelligence including: self-awareness, self regulation, social awareness, and relationship management. • Analyze the impact emotional intelligence has on effective leadership. • Understand how stress has an impact on both the leader and their ability to lead. • Utilize empathy as a tool to develop stronger relationships and healthy team/organization culture.
Time for Facilitation	Between 20 - 120 minutes

Introduction

Brief Starting Intro:

Emotional intelligence encompasses key components such as self-awareness, self-regulation, social awareness, and relationship management. *Self-awareness* allows leaders to recognize their own emotions and understand how these emotions affect their thoughts and actions. This awareness is essential for making informed decisions and maintaining authenticity in leadership. *Self-regulation*, on the other hand, helps leaders manage their emotions, especially in high-pressure situations, enabling them to remain calm and composed. This ability to control impulsive reactions and stay focused under stress is vital for maintaining a positive and productive work environment.

Additionally, *social awareness* and *relationship management* are critical for building strong, effective teams. Social awareness involves understanding and empathizing with the emotions of others, which is crucial for fostering a supportive and inclusive workplace culture. It allows leaders to anticipate the needs and concerns of their team members, enhancing communication and collaboration. Relationship management involves using this understanding to navigate social complexities, manage conflicts, and build strong relationships. Leaders who are adept in these areas can inspire and motivate their teams, create a positive work environment, and manage change more effectively.

Pre-Facilitation: Check with participants to see if they watched the video and read the resource articles. They should have both watched and read the resources prior to asking the following questions.

Best Practice Facilitation: Place participants into pairs of two so that they can share first with the other participant before sharing their answer with the whole group. This "pair and share" technique allows individuals to test out their answer(s) with someone else first (instilling confidence in the answer) and helps to start building stronger relationships with others in the program.

Depending on the time you have, select the questions that work within your schedule for training. Since we are utilizing the "pair and share" method, you should provide the participants with 2 minutes each to discuss their answers (let them know when to switch to keep them on time). Then have those who want to share their answers with the whole group a chance to do so (select 2 or 3 people to share - do not force participation). This can take up to 5 minutes. In total the pair and share technique for each question will take approximately 10 minutes. If you do not use the pair and share, allow 5-7 minutes for individuals to respond to the who group.

Emotional Intelligence General Questions

The following questions are based on the Emotional Intelligence video:

1. The video discusses how emotions impact us both personally and professionally. How do you typically react to high-pressure situations at work? Reflecting on this answer, what patterns have you noticed in your emotional responses over time? How do you think these reactions affect your decision-making and interactions with your team?
2. What techniques do you use to manage your emotions during stressful situations? How effective have these techniques been in helping you maintain composure? Are there any new strategies you would like to try to improve emotional stability?
3. If you were to ask 5 people who know you best the question, "How do emotions impact my leadership?" What would they likely say? Why do you think they would respond in that particular way? When you think about you own authentic leadership style, how do you utilize emotions to arouse, sustain and direct activity with your team?

4. How are emotions currently impacting your team, department, or company culture? Have you ever experienced a collective culture that was negative? What impact did emotions have on that culture? Have you ever experienced a collective culture that was positive? What impact did emotions have on that culture? What role can you play as a leader to ensure that emotions impact your culture in a positive way?
5. What techniques do you use to intentionally regulate emotions (such as deep breathing, progressive muscle relaxation, or grounding exercises)? Do those techniques differ based on the emotions you are experiencing? Why or why not? What recommendations would you have for other leaders who are struggling to manage their emotions?
6. How have you utilized cognitive reframing in the past? What was the impact of utilizing this emotional regulation technique on the situation? How can you help others on your team utilize cognitive reframing more often?

Additional Activity on Emotional Intelligence:

1. Self-Assessment: Begin the workshop by providing participants with the Emotional Intelligence Self-Assessment questionnaire provided. Encourage them to reflect on their current level of Emotional Intelligence. Ask participants to rate their effectiveness in key areas such as self-awareness, self-regulation, social awareness, and relationship management.
2. Group Discussion: Facilitate a group discussion where participants share their self-assessment results and insights. Encourage open dialogue about common challenges and best practices for dealing with emotions in leadership. Guide participants to identify common themes and patterns in addressing emotions both personally and professionally.

Recognizing and Addressing Stress in Yourself and Others

Questions

The following questions are based on the Recognizing and Addressing Stress Article:

1. What are some common physical symptoms you notice in yourself when you're stressed? How do these symptoms affect your daily performance and interactions with others? Have you noticed any patterns in when these symptoms occur, such as during specific tasks or situations?
2. How do emotional signs of stress manifest in your leadership style? How do these emotional fluctuations influence your decision-making process? What steps do you take to manage your emotions in high-stress situations?
3. Can you describe some behavioral changes you observe in yourself when under stress? How do these changes impact your relationships with team members? Have you developed any strategies to mitigate these behavioral shifts?
4. What immediate techniques do you use to relieve stress, and how effective are they? How do these techniques help you regain control and composure? Are there any

additional strategies you would like to try in the future?

5. How do you recognize signs of stress in your team members? What actions do you take when you notice a team member showing signs of stress? How do you balance empathy with the need to maintain team productivity?
6. What long-term strategies have you implemented to manage stress in yourself and your team? How do these strategies contribute to a more supportive and productive work environment? What role does professional development play in reducing stress and enhancing your leadership skills?

Additional Recognizing and Addressing Stress Activity:

Addressing Stressors: Begin by explaining the objective of the activity - "*to identify common sources of stress in the workplace and brainstorm actionable solutions*." Emphasize the importance of open communication and collaboration in managing stress.

Identifying Stress Triggers

- Provide each participant with sticky notes and markers. Ask them to write down one or two common stress triggers they have experienced at work. Encourage them to be specific (e.g., "unclear job expectations," "tight deadlines," "lack of recognition").
- Once everyone has written their triggers, ask participants to place their sticky notes on a flip chart or large sheet of paper at the front of the room. Group similar triggers together to identify common themes.

Group Discussion and Analysis

- Review the grouped stress triggers with the entire group. Discuss the most common or impactful triggers and explore why they might be particularly stressful. Encourage participants to share personal experiences related to these triggers.

Solution Brainstorming

- Divide participants into small groups, ensuring a mix of experiences and perspectives in each group. Assign each group one or two common stress triggers identified during the previous step.
- Instruct each group to brainstorm potential solutions or strategies to mitigate the assigned stress triggers. Encourage them to think creatively and consider both immediate and long-term solutions. They should write their ideas on a flip chart or large sheet of paper.

Group Presentations

- Have each group present their stress triggers and the solutions they brainstormed. Encourage other participants to ask questions or offer additional suggestions.

Utilizing Empathy Questions

The following questions are based on the Utilizing Empathy Article:

1. How do you define empathy in the context of leadership and why do you believe it is important? Can you recall a situation where your empathetic response positively impacted your team? What challenges have you faced when trying to empathize with others in a professional setting?
2. What are some practical ways you demonstrate cognitive empathy with your team? How does understanding your team members' perspectives influence your decision-making? Have you ever experienced a situation where cognitive empathy helped resolve a conflict? Describe the outcome.
3. How do you balance emotional empathy with maintaining professionalism and objectivity? Can you share an experience where emotional empathy led to a difficult decision-making process? What strategies do you use to ensure that emotional empathy does not cloud your judgment?
4. Describe a time when compassionate empathy motivated you to take supportive action for a team member. How did you determine the appropriate level of support to provide? What was the outcome, and how did it affect your relationship with the team member and the team as a whole?
5. What are some potential downsides of being overly empathetic as a leader, and how do you mitigate these risks? Have you ever felt emotionally exhausted or overwhelmed by being too empathetic? How did you handle it? How do you set boundaries to maintain a healthy balance between empathy and professional distance?
6. In what ways can practicing active listening enhance your empathy and overall leadership effectiveness? What specific techniques do you use to ensure you are actively listening to your team members? How do you follow up after conversations to demonstrate that you value what was shared?

Additional Utilizing Empathy Activity:

Empathy Mapping Objective: To help participants understand and practice empathy mapping as a leadership tool, enabling them to better understand their team members' perspectives, emotions, and needs. This exercise aims to enhance participants' emotional intelligence, particularly in the areas of social awareness and relationship management.

What is Empathy Mapping?

Empathy mapping is a visual tool used to gain a deeper understanding of others' experiences and perspectives. It involves creating a representation of a person's emotional state by exploring what they might be thinking, feeling, saying, and doing in a particular situation. This tool is valuable in leadership as it helps leaders better connect with their team members, fostering empathy and improving communication and collaboration.

Introduction

- Provide an overview of the empathy map structure, highlighting the four main quadrants: **Thinking**, **Feeling**, **Saying**, and **Doing**.

Group Formation and Scenario Assignment

- Divide participants into small groups (4-6 people per group). Assign each group a specific scenario that could occur in a workplace setting (scenarios are provided in this facilitation guide). Scenarios might include dealing with a team member who is overwhelmed, handling a conflict between colleagues, or managing a team during organizational change.
- Hand out the empathy map provided in this facilitation guide.

Creating the Empathy Map

- Each group will create an empathy map for the fictional character in their scenario. They will:
  - **Thinking**: Write down what the person might be thinking about the situation.
  - **Feeling**: Note the emotions they might be experiencing.
  - **Saying**: List possible things the person might be saying about the situation.
  - **Doing**: Describe the behaviors they might exhibit as a result.
- Individuals can write down their thoughts on their individual Empathy Map (for each quadrant). Encourage them to be specific and consider the person's perspective thoroughly.
- Have the team share what they wrote down individually with the entire team. The team will need to create one Empathy Map that they will share with the entire class.

Discussion and Reflection

- Have each group present their empathy map to the larger group. As they present, encourage other participants to ask questions or offer additional insights.
- Discuss common themes and differences among the scenario. Highlight the importance of recognizing diverse emotional and psychological responses.

Application and Action Planning

- After the presentations, ask each group to discuss how the insights gained from the empathy map can inform their leadership practices. Specifically, how can they use this understanding to address the situation effectively?
- Groups should create a brief action plan outlining steps they can take to support their team members based on the empathy mapping exercise.

Conclusion and Takeaways

- Encourage participants to incorporate empathy mapping into their regular leadership practices, whether for team meetings, conflict resolution, or personal reflection.

General Emotional Intelligence Self Assessment

Instructions: Please rate each statement on a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 indicates "Strongly Disagree" and 5 indicates "Strongly Agree."

1. I am aware of my emotions as they arise.

1 2 3 4 5

2. I use cognitive reframing to look at issues from a positive perspective.

1 2 3 4 5

3. I understand how my mood affects my thoughts and behavior.

1 2 3 4 5

4. I can easily recognize when I am stressed.

1 2 3 4 5

5. I regularly reflect on my feelings and reactions to situations.

1 2 3 4 5

6. I can stay calm under pressure.

1 2 3 4 5

7. I am good at managing my impulsive reactions.

1 2 3 4 5

8. I can adjust my approach when faced with new challenges.

1 2 3 4 5

9. I recover quickly from setbacks or failures.

1 2 3 4 5

10. I can keep disruptive emotions and impulses in check.

1 2 3 4 5

11. I am sensitive to others' emotions and feelings.

1 2 3 4 5

12. I pay attention to non-verbal cues like body language and facial expressions.

1 2 3 4 5

13. I try to understand things from other people's perspectives.

1 2 3 4 5

14. I am aware of the social dynamics in group settings.

1 2 3 4 5

15. I can sense when something is bothering someone else, even if they don't say it.

1 2 3 4 5

16. I find it easy to communicate with others, even in difficult situations.

1 2 3 4 5

17. I can resolve conflicts in a constructive manner.

1 2 3 4 5

18. I build and maintain healthy relationships with my colleagues.

1 2 3 4 5

19. I encourage and support the emotional well-being of my team.

1 2 3 4 5

20.I can influence and inspire others to work towards common goals.

1 2 3 4 5

Scoring: Calculate your total score by adding up the ratings for each statement. A higher score indicates stronger Emotional Intelligence skills and habits.

Total Score: _____

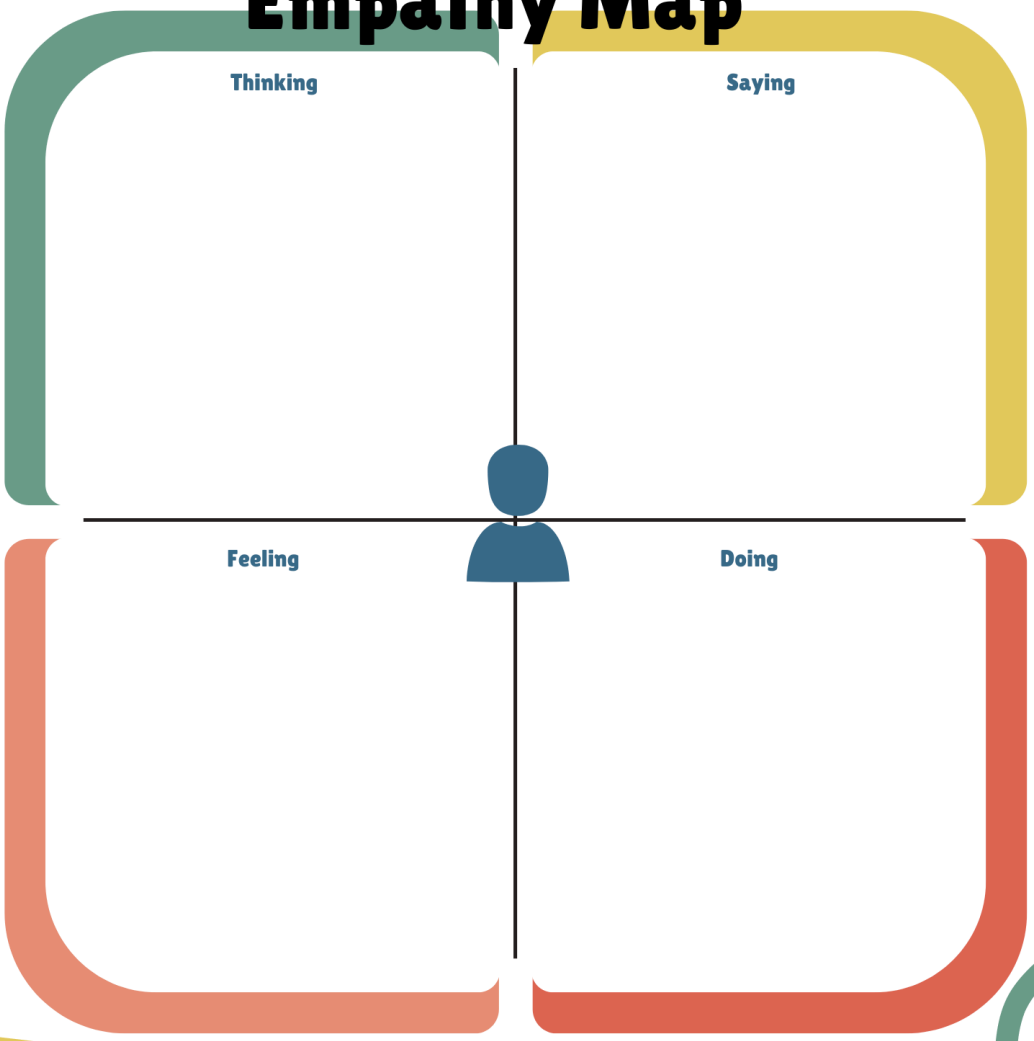
Interpretation:

- **80-100**: **High Emotional Intelligence**
  You have a strong understanding and application of emotional intelligence. You are self-

aware, manage your emotions well, are socially aware, and excel in managing relationships. This makes you an effective leader and communicator.

- **60-79**: **Moderate Emotional Intelligence**
  You have a good grasp of emotional intelligence but may have areas to develop further. Reflect on the specific components where your scores were lower and consider strategies for improvement. Overall, you are likely to navigate social situations competently.
- **40-59**: **Developing Emotional Intelligence**
  You have some awareness of emotional intelligence but may struggle with certain aspects. It would be beneficial to focus on building specific skills, such as self-regulation or social awareness, to enhance your overall emotional intelligence.
- **20-39**: **Low Emotional Intelligence**
  You may find it challenging to understand and manage your emotions and relationships. It is recommended to seek resources, training, or coaching to develop these skills, as they are crucial for personal and professional growth.

Empathy Map



Five specific (possible) workplace scenarios that could be used for the empathy mapping activity:

1. **Scenario 1: Overwhelmed Team Member**
   - **Situation**: A team member has been given a major project with a tight deadline. They have been working long hours and seem increasingly stressed.
   - **Context**: This team member typically excels at their job but is now showing signs of fatigue and burnout, such as arriving late, missing deadlines, and being unusually quiet during meetings.
2. **Scenario 2: Conflict Between Colleagues**
   - **Situation**: Two colleagues have had a disagreement over the approach to a project. The conflict has created tension in the team, affecting overall productivity.
   - **Context**: Both individuals are valuable contributors but have different working styles and priorities. The disagreement has led to avoidance and reduced collaboration.
3. **Scenario 3: New Team Member Struggling to Adjust**
   - **Situation**: A new employee is having difficulty integrating into the team. They seem hesitant to participate in discussions and are not as productive as expected.
   - **Context**: The new team member comes from a different industry and is still learning the ropes. They may feel overwhelmed by the company's fast-paced environment and are unsure how to fit in.
4. **Scenario 4: Employee Facing Personal Challenges**
   - **Situation**: An employee has recently experienced a significant personal challenge, such as a family illness or divorce. Their work performance has noticeably declined.
   - **Context**: The employee used to be highly reliable and proactive but now seems distracted and less engaged. They have missed a few deadlines and have been taking frequent days off.
5. **Scenario 5: Team Member Feeling Underappreciated**
   - **Situation**: A long-term team member feels their contributions are not being recognized. They have started to express dissatisfaction and seem less motivated.
   - **Context**: This employee has consistently delivered quality work but has not received any formal recognition or career advancement opportunities. Their morale has dropped, and they are considering leaving the company.